

Mass extinction events from 499 million years ago to the present.

Ordovician: 485 to 444 million years ago.

Ordovician: global cooling leads to the extinction of 85 per cent of marine life.

Silurian: 444 to 419 million years ago.

Devonian: 419 to 359 million years ago.

Late Devonian: A rapid drop in sea level is one of a number of possible causes for the loss of 70 to 80 per cent of animal species.

Carboniferous: 359 to 299 million years ago.

Permian: 299 to 252 million years ago.

Permian Huge volcanic activity helps to wipe out 96 per cent of all marine species.

Triassic: 252 to 201 million years ago.